

Career Advice

Job hunting ▾

Cover letters

How to tailor your cover letter to the job



SEEK content team – updated on 10 December, 2019

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Cover letters are your chance to show you're the exact job on offer.

Plenty of recruiters will notice your cover letter. As Robert H. Smith, director at Robert H. Smith & Co. noticed.

The purpose of a cover letter is to show your resume, says Peter L. ...

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... is tailored to the

... s Andrew Morris, your cover letter gets

... look at your keep it simple. Less

is more, especially in the era of email applications. Employers are looking for key words at this stage to see if it's worth reading your resume. You might even want to bold the important words.

The purpose of a cover letter is to get a recruiter or employer to look at your resume, says Peter Noblet, senior regional director at Hays.

- **Remember every cover letter is important.** It's too easy in the world we live to apply for dozens of jobs through SEEK, says Noblet. Make sure, however, that every single cover letter is individualised for the job in question. If your cover letter nails it you're going to stand out to an employer. The process of tailoring your cover letter also makes you think about the job and if it is really the right role for you.
- **Concentrate on two or three key words from the job advertisement.** Make sure you match your capabilities against each word in a separate bullet point. Be succinct and give relevant examples, says Noblet. If, for example, the advertisement mentions SEO skills you could highlight this with a bullet point. Weave a variety of key SEO skills into that point such as your technical optimisation skills, social media marketing skills, link building expertise, your understanding of information architecture, and content marketing skills. But keep it brief. You just want to grab the reader's attention for now.
- **Explain why you're interested in the job.** Explain in a sentence why you want this particular job. "Pique the reader's interest" says Noblet. Explain very specifically what it is that makes this the job for you. It may, for example, be that it will use your fabulous problem solving skills. Or it allows you to use both your creative and research skills. Tie it back to how your skills will benefit the organisation.
- **Summarise with your unique selling point (USP).** What's different about you? asks Noblet. Explain why you're the best fit for this particular role and how your USP fits. Make sure you understand what the organisation wants. If your standard USP concentrates on handling big projects single-handedly, but the job involves brainstorming with a team you might want to change the wording slightly. Or if the cover letter to needs to be tailored to this person's

Finally, review your resume?"

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or your USP in the cover letter

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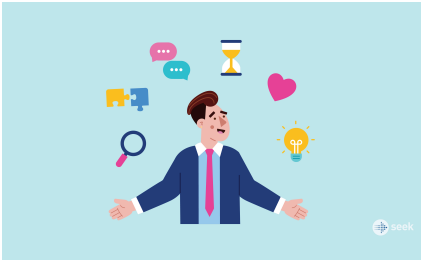
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